

Kansas Rural Health Transformation Program  
Community Health Worker (CHW) + Accountable Food is Medicine (AFIM) Awarded  
Project Descriptions

- Hutchinson Regional Medical Center, Inc: \$150,000
  - Implement an integrated rural health model that connects high-risk patients in Reno County with CHW support, nutrition-based interventions, chronic disease monitoring, and community resource navigation. Includes linking support services like WIC and partnering with K-State Extension.
- Hospital District No. 6 of Harper County, Kansas: \$150,000
  - Launch a Community Health Worker and Accountable Food is Medicine (CHW+AFIM) program targeting type 2 diabetes through whole-person, patient-centered lifestyle medicine, with the registered dietitian-designed nutrition (AFIM) intervention and the CHW at its center. Pair food-as-medicine with CHW-delivered lifestyle-medicine coaching so the CHW team can remove the real barriers to healthier choices.
- Great Plains of Smith County, Inc: \$150,000
  - Implement a fully integrated Community Health Worker (CHW) + Accountable Food Is Medicine (AFIM) model to improve outcomes for rural Kansans with prediabetes, Type 2 diabetes, gestational diabetes, and hypertension. With SCMh's project, the CHW is embedded within existing clinical workflows and the model is uniquely strengthened by a dual-trained Registered Dietitian/Executive Chef, enabling direct translation of clinical nutrition guidance into practical, culturally appropriate food interventions.
- Hospital District No. 1 of Dickinson County, Kansas, DBA Memorial Health System: \$150,000
  - Implement the Healthy Dickinson County Initiative, a comprehensive program designed to improve outcomes for patients with diabetes and hypertension by integrating CHWs, medically tailored meals, social determinants of health (SDOH) screening and community resource navigation. Memorial Health System will leverage its Food and Nutrition Services Department and collaborate with a registered dietitian to develop and produce medically tailored meals designed specifically for patients with diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular disease, and other nutrition-sensitive conditions.
- CommonSpirit Kansas, Inc: \$149,960
  - Implement a comprehensive Community Health Worker (CHW) and Accountable Food is Medicine (AFIM) program across Western Kansas. Embed CHWs within multidisciplinary clinical teams who will identify, track,

and close social and structural barriers to health. Establish robust food is medicine infrastructure, with inclusion of evidence-based nutrition education, local resource navigation, federal benefit enrollment assistance, collaboratively created produce prescriptions, and potential development of medically tailored groceries and/or meals.

- Citizens Foundation: \$146,476
  - Expand established Community Health Worker (CHW) program and fully implement an Accountable Food is Medicine (AFIM) initiative, integrating clinical care with community-based support to bridge the gap between medical treatment and long-term health management. Leverage on-campus food pantry as a clinical entry point and partner with registered dietitians through in-person and telehealth consultation to provide evidence-based, localized and professionally managed dietary interventions. Supported by a robust medical staff of 30 providers, including 10 family practice physicians, seven of whom specialize in obstetrics, along with two general surgeons, 10 nurse practitioners, and six physician assistants.
- Newman Memorial County Hospital: \$110,716
  - Expand established Community Health Worker (CHW) program to include a structured, clinically integrated AFIM model with new workflows, nutrition-focused interventions, enhanced patient monitoring, expanded food access partnerships, cooking and nutrition education initiatives, outcome tracking, and sustainable reimbursement mechanisms. This includes a robust provider team with dietitians and CHWs integrated into workflow and collaboration with existing partners.